ABOUT THIS PIECE

Sample IEP: dyslexia and ADHD

Katherine Conklin

WHAT IT IS

A sample Individualized Education Program for a 3rd-grade student with dyslexia (specific learning disability) and ADHD (other health impairment). Name and personal details removed.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The present levels of performance, the goals, and the accommodations.

The work itself starts on the next page.

Individualized Education Program: Dyslexia and ADHD

Sample IEP · Grade 3 · Student name and personal details removed · Katherine Conklin

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Grade Level: 3rd Grade

Eligibility Category: Specific Learning Disability (Dyslexia), Other Health Impairment (ADHD)

1. Present Levels of Academic and Functional Performance (PLAFP)

Strengths

- Enjoys hands-on learning activities and group discussions.
- Shows creativity and enthusiasm in storytelling and oral discussions.
- Strong problem-solving skills and critical thinking.

Challenges

- Difficulty decoding words, recognizing sight words, and spelling.
- Struggles with reading fluency and comprehension.
- Difficulty staying focused and organized during tasks.
- Trouble with task initiation and completing assignments independently.

Impact on Learning

- The student's dyslexia affects their ability to read at grade level, impacting comprehension and written expression.
- ADHD contributes to difficulty maintaining attention, following multi-step directions, and organizing thoughts in writing.

2. Measurable Annual Goals

Reading Goal

By the end of the IEP period, the student will improve reading fluency from 40 words per minute to 80 words per minute with 90% accuracy, as measured by teacher observation, fluency assessments, and progress monitoring.

Short-Term Objectives

1. Use multisensory strategies (e.g., Orton-Gillingham) to decode unfamiliar words with 80% accuracy.

2. Increase sight word recognition from 50% to 85% on grade-level high-frequency word lists.

3. Read a short passage and answer comprehension questions with 80% accuracy.

Writing Goal

The student will independently write a five-sentence paragraph with appropriate capitalization, punctuation, and spelling of high-frequency words with 80% accuracy in 4 out of 5 attempts.

Short-Term Objectives

1. Use graphic organizers to plan writing.
2. Spell 15 high-frequency words correctly in written assignments.
3. Edit and revise sentences using a checklist with teacher guidance.

Attention & Executive Functioning Goal

The student will use self-regulation strategies (e.g., checklist, timers, movement breaks) to stay on task for 15-minute increments in 4 out of 5 observed sessions.

Short-Term Objectives

1. Use a timer or checklist to complete classroom tasks with 75% success.
2. Follow multi-step directions with minimal redirection in 3 out of 4 attempts.
3. Independently use an organizational system (folder, planner) to track assignments.

3. Accommodations & Modifications

Accommodations

- Extended time on assignments and assessments.
- Access to audiobooks and text-to-speech software.
- Preferential seating to reduce distractions.
- Chunking assignments into smaller, manageable steps.
- Use of graphic organizers for writing assignments.
- Frequent movement breaks.
- Visual schedules and step-by-step instructions.
- Frequent check-ins for understanding.
- Allow oral responses or dictation instead of written responses when appropriate.

Modifications (if needed)

- Reduced number of spelling words or math problems.
- Simplified reading passages while maintaining content integrity.
- Alternative grading for written work (e.g., focus on content over spelling).

4. Special Education & Related Services

- Specialized Reading Instruction (Orton-Gillingham or similar) - 4x per week, 30 minutes per session.
- Small Group Writing Support - 3x per week, 30 minutes per session.
- Executive Functioning Coaching (Organizational Skills, Attention Strategies) - 2x per week, 20 minutes per session.
- Speech-Language Therapy (if needed for language processing) - 1x per week, 30 minutes per session.

- Occupational Therapy Consultation (for handwriting support, if needed).

5. Assessment & Progress Monitoring

- Biweekly reading fluency checks.
- Teacher logs of on-task behavior and work completion.
- Writing samples collected and reviewed monthly.
- Quarterly progress reports aligned with IEP goals.
- Annual standardized reading and writing assessments.

6. Transition & Additional Considerations

- Student will receive support in transitioning to independent reading and writing strategies.
- Parent communication will include weekly check-ins and progress updates.
- Collaboration between general education and special education teachers to ensure consistent support.